

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in a UK newspaper:

ELON MUSK AND JAPANESE BILLIONAIRE TO SEND EIGHT ARTISTS TO THE MOON

'I did not want to have such a fantastic experience by myself'

Elon Musk's rocket company SpaceX is sending a Japanese billionaire and eight artists on the first private trip around the moon. Japanese billionaire Yusaku Maezawa will pay for himself and between six and eight creative people like film directors, poets and painters to take the week-long trip. He hopes it will become a major international event. He is set to make the trip in 2023, and he will fill the rocket with a range of different artists from Earth.

Mr Maezawa, 42, said he wants his guests for the lunar orbit "to see the moon up close, and the Earth in full view, and create work to reflect their experience." Mr Musk said the trip will cost "a lot of money", but declined to disclose the exact amount. Such missions are thought to cost at least US\$150 million. "I did not want to have such a fantastic experience by myself," said Mr Maezawa. "I wish to create amazing works of art for humankind."

He didn't immediately say who will be on his guest list for the spaceflight. The mission will not involve a lunar landing. Space tourism began in 2001 when California businessman Dennis Tito paid for a journey on a Russian rocket to the International Space Station. SpaceX already has a long list of firsts, with its sights ultimately set on Mars.

Your English teacher has asked your class to write an essay entitled: 'Space travel is a good use of money.' You have been asked to discuss this topic in groups first. You may want to talk about:

- why people are so interested in space travel
- whether space tourism will become popular
- whether there are better ways to spend money
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Are you interested in space travel?
2. Would you like to be a space tourist?
3. Will people live on the moon in our lifetime?
4. What would be the most enjoyable thing about a space flight?
5. Who else should be taken on the space trip?
6. What problems will long space journeys cause?
7. Should space travel be organised by private companies or by governments?
8. What qualities do you need to be a space traveller?